

Distraction Blockers: Which Type Is Right for You?

Distraction blockers are apps that restrict your access to distracting websites and apps on a schedule you set. Not all blockers work the same way, but picking the right type makes a big difference.

Hard Blockers

Shut you out completely. You designate apps and websites, set your schedule, and when a block is active, those things are unavailable.



Freedom
(iPhone, Android, Mac, PC)
freedom.to



Opal
(iPhone only)
opal.so

Friction Blockers

Make you wait 10-60 seconds before opening a designated app. During the wait, you often come to your senses.



ClearSpace (iPhone, paid)
clearspace.app



ScreenZen (iPhone and Android, free)
screenzen.co

Why friction can work better: People delete hard blockers out of frustration. Friction blockers feel more collaborative, less like a top-down imposition.

The iPhone Problem

On iPhone, you can disable any third-party blocker through Screen Time settings. (Android is better here.) Two workarounds:

✓ *Use friction blockers.*
You're not fully locked out, so the urge to go nuclear is much weaker.

✓ *Use Screen Time directly.*
Less flexible, but you can set a Screen Time passcode and give it to someone you trust - a truly hard block.

